CivicConnect: Authority Invite Code Guide

Each invite code works **once**, for **one area**, and expires after a set number of days. Follow these steps every time a new officer needs an account.

Step 0: Save the generator script (one time only)

Create a file named `invite.js` and paste the lines below into it. The file `invite.js` is also provided next to this PDF, so you can just copy that file instead. Every line is short, so nothing is cut off or lost.

```
const crypto = require('crypto');
const area = process.argv[2] || 'Ongole';
const days = parseInt(process.argv[3] || '7', 10);
if (!/^[A-Za-z ]+$/.test(area) || !(days > 0)) {
  console.log('Usage: node invite.js Ongole 7');
  process.exit(1);
}
const abc = 'ABCDEFGHJKLMNPQRSTUVWXYZ23456789';
const part = () => Array.from({ length: 4 }, () =>
  abc[crypto.randomInt(abc.length)]).join('');
const code = 'CIVIC-' + part() + '-' + part() + '-' + part();
const hash = crypto.createHash('sha256').update(code).digest('hex');
const sql =
  "INSERT INTO authority_invites (id,code_hash,area,expires_at) VALUES " +
  "('inv_'||substr(md5(random()::text),1,12),'" + hash + "','" + area +
  "',NOW()+INTERVAL '" + days + " days');";
console.log('CODE: ' + code);
console.log(sql);
```

Step 1: Generate a code

Run this in a terminal from the folder that contains `invite.js`. No internet needed. The first word is the area and the number is the days until it expires:

```
node invite.js Ongole 7
```

It prints two lines:

- `CODE: CIVIC-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX` is the invite code. Copy it somewhere safe.
- `INSERT INTO authority_invites ...` is the SQL line for the database.

Step 2: Save it in Neon

1. Open the Neon Console and go to **Postgres database > SQL Editor**.
2. Press **Ctrl+A** and delete the old text.
3. Paste the `INSERT ...` line and click **Run**.
4. Look for "Statement executed successfully".

Step 3: Use the code

On the authority sign-up page, choose the same area (for example **Ongole**) and enter the `CODE:` value.

Other areas and expiry

Change the two values after `invite.js`:

```
node invite.js Guntur 3
```

Each code works once, so run the command again for each new officer. The area must match the name shown in the sign-up dropdown.

Check your codes

Run this in the Neon SQL Editor. A filled `used_at` means that code was used:

```
SELECT id, area, used_at, expires_at FROM authority_invites;
```

Troubleshooting

- **"That invite code is not valid":** the INSERT was not run in Neon, or the backend uses a different database. Check that the backend's DATABASE_URL points to the same Neon project.
- **"Only valid for (area)":** the area chosen on the sign-up page does not match the area in the invite.
- **Keep AUTHORITY_INVITE_CODE empty** on the backend host. Setting it to the old public code stops the server from starting in production.
- **Never share your database connection string** in screenshots or chat. If it leaks, reset the password in Neon and update DATABASE_URL on the backend host.